established. [18] UFWD operates inside India in more than one way. Beyond its standard tactic of trying to influence Indian opinion-makers through Chinese business persons, academics or cultural personalities, its control over the Chinese organizations dealing with ethnic and religious affairs permits the UFWD to penetrate deep into the Tibetan refugee community as well as the Buddhist congregations in India. With respect to the Tibetan refugee community, it reminds them that they are a part of the 'Chinese family', and co-opts the pro-China Tibetan refugees while coercing the less willing to work for it.

With respect to the Buddhist congregation in India, it seeks to manipulate Buddhism through the Chinese Buddhist Association and its state-approved clergy. UFWD regards its work in India as key to gaining control over the World Buddhist Movement, which will make it easier for China to have greater penetration in other countries with significant Buddhist followers. Among the powerful tools at UFWD's disposal are the Confucius Institutes that have been subsumed under the UFWD since 2018. These are, superficially, Chinese language and culture teaching institutions, but their real purpose is to directly influence research and academic communities that publish writings on China, by offering finances and human resources to cash-strapped academic institutions in India. Even though India was, perhaps, the first country to express alarm at the functioning of the Confucius Institutes abroad, the Chinese continue to look for opportunities to penetrate the Indian higher education system. In the guise of promoting education, religion and culture, the UFWD seeks to shape Indian thinking on critical issues under negotiation between India and China through important domestic constituencies.

The International Department (ILD) of the Chinese Communist Party (*Zhongyang Duiwai Lianluo Bu*) is another